FRIDAH KANANA

Operations Professional | Procurement • Administration • M&E | 9+ Years Driving Efficiency, Compliance & Organizational Excellence

+254 726 232 429 | fridahkanana@yahoo.com | Nairobi, Kenya

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operations and M&E professional with 9+ years driving efficiency across multiple USAID-funded programs within a large international organization. Expert in USAID-compliant procurement, finance processes, and large-scale event logistics (totaling 1200+ participants). Deliver seamless executive support, calendar management, vendor negotiations, and expense reconciliations while coordinating effectively across executives, multicultural teams, and external stakeholders. Consistently design systems that reduce processing times by up to 40% and strengthen compliance in fast-paced, development-focused environments.

ACHIEVEMENTS

• Reduced consultant onboarding time by 40%, improving project readiness and compliance documentation.

• Increased SACCO data accuracy by 25% and reduced submission delays by 60%, strengthening performance reporting and enabling evidence-based decision-making.

• Orchestrated 20+ institutional capacity-building workshops annually across Nairobi, Mombasa, and other counties, engaging 1,000+ SACCO representatives, partner organizations, and technical consultants (20-60 per session), consistently delivering on-time, under-budget execution with full donor and organizational compliance.

• Maintained 100% USAID audit compliance across multiple operational and procurement cycles.

• Streamlined expense processing workflows, cutting reimbursement turnaround by 70% and improving accountability.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Operations, Administration & Logistics: Executive support • Calendar & meeting coordination • Travel & mission logistics • Workshop & event management • Records & database management • Policy & procedural compliance.

Finance, Procurement & Compliance: Expense & invoice processing • Travel advances & reconciliations • Vendor sourcing & negotiations • Procurement support • Budget monitoring • USAID & donor compliance • Audit readiness.

Program Support, M&E & Collaboration: Cross-functional coordination • Stakeholder engagement • Data collection & analysis • Monitoring & reporting • Process improvement • Deadline & deliverable tracking.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

• **Microsoft Ecosystem**: Microsoft 365, Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive.

• **Google Workspace**: Google Forms, Google Sheets, Google Docs, Google Drive.

• **Project Management & Collaboration**: Asana, Monday.com, Knack, World Time Buddy.

• **Communication Platforms**: Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Google Meet, Skype, Slack.

• **Data Collection & Analysis**: Google Forms, Survey tools, Excel (Data Analysis).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

World Council of Credit Unions (WOCCU) — Nairobi, Kenya
Operations & Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning Officer (April 2020 – March 2025)

• Coordinated 20+ workshops and training sessions annually across Nairobi, Mombasa, and other counties, managing participant databases of 1,000+ stakeholders and overseeing end-to-end logistics including venue arrangements, hotel bookings, vendor payments, and participant reimbursements.

• Monitored event budgets and prepared high-quality post-event and financial reports, ensuring 100% on-time submissions and full compliance with donor and organizational requirements.

• Planned and coordinated domestic and international travel for 60+ staff, consultants, and executives annually including flight bookings, accommodations, ground transportation, visas, and VIP airport clearance, while ensuring 100% compliance with organizational travel policies.

• Prepared and processed 100+ staff travel advance requests annually, reviewed Back-to-Office Reports (BTORs), and reconciled expense reports with supporting documentation, ensuring 100% accuracy, policy compliance, and faster reimbursements.

• Reduced inter-office communication response times by 20% by proactively serving as liaison between Madison HQ and Kenya office, escalating time-sensitive matters and building strong cross-cultural professional relationships. Provided comprehensive administrative support to Kenya Country Coordinator and senior leadership across Washington DC and Madison offices by managing calendars, scheduling cross-regional meetings and conference calls, coordinating executive engagements, and ensuring seamless coordination using Slack, Microsoft Teams, and email.

• Designed and implemented consultant recruitment tracking process covering the entire lifecycle from solicitation to onboarding, reducing onboarding time by 40% through proactive problem-solving and thoughtful process innovation.

• Contributed to policy development, including drafting sections of the Kenya Employee Manual that improved HR documentation accuracy and transparency.

• Supported HR operations including recruitment coordination (job postings, RFP solicitation), onboarding (reducing processing time by 25%), leave tracking, and payroll statutory deductions while maintaining 100% compliance with Kenyan labor laws and organizational policies.

• Led procurement operations including office supplies and inventory management, supplier sourcing, quotation evaluation, negotiations (achieving average cost savings of 15%), and contract management;

conducted due diligence on selected vendors against SAM, OFAC & UN Sanctions lists and ensured full compliance with USAID and internal audit standards.

• Monitored deadlines, deliverables, and follow-ups across 2+ concurrent projects, achieving 100% on-time task completion and maintaining detailed progress reports that enabled leadership decision-making.

• Assisted in co-creating an M&E toolkit for systematic data collection from 10 SACCOs, improving data accuracy by 25% and reducing submission delays by 60%, which enhanced development and donor impact reporting.

• Managed ongoing data collection, validation, and analysis of SACCO-level performance data to produce quarterly insights that informed program strategies and strengthened evidence-based decision-making.

World Council of Credit Unions (WOCCU) — Nairobi, Kenya

Operations and Assistant Accountant Officer (January 2016 – March 2020)

• Streamlined the expense-processing workflow, cutting funds-disbursement and reimbursement timelines by 35% and boosting operational efficiency.

• Delivered executive support to Country Coordinator and senior staff by managing complex calendars across 3 time zones, coordinating 100+ stakeholder meetings annually, and ensuring 98% meeting attendance through strategic scheduling and follow-up.

• Introduced internal control requisition forms for travel advances, vendor payments, petty cash and vehicle permissions, reducing processing errors by 25% and standardizing policy compliance across the organization.

• Maintained accurate records of petty cash, processed accounts payable and receivable and managed office checkbooks achieving zero reconciliation discrepancies to ensure proper financial handling and procedural adherence.

• Created staff exit and clearance procedures, ensuring audit trail compliance with 100% adherence across 20+ staff transitions and smooth offboarding.

• Coordinated scheduling for the project vehicles transporting field staff across multiple counties, maintaining 100% transport policy compliance and achieving zero safety incidents over 4 years through systematic maintenance and proactive driver coordination.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Commerce (Finance Option), Kenya College of Accountancy (KCA University) | 2012 – 2014

Diploma in Business Administration, Foundation Institute of Africa | KNEC | 2009 – 2011

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

• Monitoring & Evaluation for Development Projects – USAID
• Data Analysis with Excel – Ongoing || Foundations of Project Management - Ongoing